



The Shack
Mill Road
Ballasalla
Isle of Man
IM9 2EG

Isle of Man Amateur Radio Society

Minutes of the Committee Meeting of Friday, 11th September 2026.

The Meeting opened at 19:30BST.

Apologies: None

Present: Richard GD8EXI, John GD0TFG, Robert GD0GGO, Stuart GD0OUD, and Keith GD5IOM

Secretary's Report

Membership stands at 32.

Transfer of the iomars.im domain, website hosting, and git repository to the committee is in progress; DNS has not yet been handed over.

Minutes and other documents to be uploaded to the website. The Dropbox system remains operational in the interim.

Treasurer's Report

Total at Bank: £4,782.54

Repeater Fund: £462.83

Club funds: £4,319.71

Cash in hand: £140.35

The first invoice for bank account charges has been received: £4.25 per month.

Chris GD6TWF, the club's internal auditor, has confirmed he is comfortable with the cash transfer arrangements.

Chairman's Report

Four members attended a Pulsar talk; a possible collaboration with the IoM Astronomy Society was discussed.

The planned SOTA activation on 6 September did not go ahead; some members operated from home.

Minutes and further documents to be uploaded to the website.

Upcoming Events

September to December schedule:

16 September – Ballasalla: no programme item currently scheduled.

20 September – Possible operation from the mobile shack for the 4m AFS daytime contest.

24 September – Creg ny Baa: first meeting there for some time; going ahead.

7 October – Antenna test range event.

21 October – Ballasalla: nothing scheduled; possible Meshcore/Meshtastic or Direwolf session.

29 October – Possible Pulsar talk (to be confirmed).

4 November – VHF contest seminar: Richard to give a talk at the Ballasalla shack.

26 November – Annual Christmas meal; booking to be made for under 20 people.

2 December – Likely date for the AGM (pencilled in).

Club Projects

Mobile Shack:

The committee discussed converting the mobile shack to a fixed/static installation, potentially available to all members.

Aerials and wire on site to be confirmed.

Antenna bracket for the vehicle to be considered to simplify future deployments.

Possible use for the 4m AFS daytime contest on Sunday 20 September.

Collaboration with IoM Astronomy Society:

Following the recent Pulsar talk, a possible collaboration was discussed.

Andy Windslade has offered to give a talk, potentially at the Creg ny Baa.

The committee discussed a Jocelyn Bell-style pulsar detection experiment.

This would require multiple KrakenSDR units and dipoles; a large Yagi was also noted as a possible alternative.

Richard to investigate further.

Club Winter Project – Preamplifier:

Preamp modules to be ordered by Richard.

A transmit delay/sequencer to be configured.

Bias-T signalling to be investigated.

Noise figure measurement sessions planned, including disabling AGC on commercial rigs to measure noise output.

Note: noise measurements at the Ballasalla shack are temperature-sensitive.

Any Other Business

John offered to assist members who wish to sell radio equipment.

Next Meeting

Friday, 9th October 2026 at 19:30BST.

The Meeting closed at 20:50BST.